



INTERNAL OPERATIONS GUIDE

OBSIDIAN + GIT BACKUP & SYNC GUIDE

How the Completeful knowledge vault is backed up to GitHub, the everyday sync workflow, and how to set it up on a new machine.



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01 AT A GLANCE

This vault is connected to a private GitHub repository. Git adds version history and an off-site backup without changing how Obsidian saves your notes.

Repository	github.com/Zachary0hill/completeful-obs (private)
Local vault	/Users/Mac/Agent-Assets-Growth/Completeful
Branch	main
Authentication	HTTPS through macOS Keychain
Obsidian plugin	Git (<code>obsidian-git</code>)

THE ONE RULE TO REMEMBER

Pull before editing. Commit-and-sync before switching devices.

02 QUICK START

After opening the Completeful vault in Obsidian:

- 1 Press `Command + P` to open the Command Palette.
- 2 Search for **Git: Commit-and-sync**.
- 3 Run the command.
- 4 Wait for the success notices confirming the commit, pull, and push.

That command saves your current vault changes to Git history, pulls any newer changes from GitHub, and pushes your changes back to GitHub.

03 EVERYDAY WORKFLOW

When you start working

- 1 Open the Completeful vault.
- 2 Press `Command + P`.
- 3 Run **Git: Pull** before editing, especially if the vault is used on another computer.

While you work

Edit notes normally. Git does not change how Obsidian saves files; it adds version history and remote backup.

When you finish working

- 1 Press **Command + P**.
- 2 Run **Git: Commit-and-sync**.
- 3 Wait for the success notices before closing Obsidian or switching computers.

04 USEFUL OBSIDIAN GIT COMMANDS

Open the Command Palette with **Command + P**, then search for one of these:

- **Git: Commit-and-sync** — Commit local changes, pull remote changes, and push to GitHub.
- **Git: Commit-and-sync with specific message** — Same, while writing a descriptive commit message.
- **Git: Pull** — Download changes made on another computer.
- **Git: Push** — Upload commits that have not yet reached GitHub.
- **Git: List changed files** — See what has changed since the last commit.
- **Git: Open source control view** — Open the Git sidebar for changes, history, staging, and diffs.
- **Git: Open history view** — Browse previous versions and commits.

05 RECOMMENDED AUTOMATIC BACKUP SETTINGS

Go to **Obsidian → Settings → Community plugins → Git**. A practical starting configuration:

- Enable pulling when Obsidian starts.
- Set automatic pull to every 10 minutes if you use more than one computer.
- Set automatic commit-and-sync or backup to every 10–15 minutes.
- Keep notifications enabled while learning the workflow so failures are visible.
- Use descriptive automatic commit messages that include the date and time.

SINGLE-MAC SETUP

If the vault is only used on this Mac, a manual **Commit-and-sync** at the end of each work session is also sufficient.

06 WHAT IS BACKED UP

The repository contains the vault's notes, PDFs, assets, templates, maps, and shareable Obsidian configuration.

These machine-specific or sensitive files are intentionally excluded by `.gitignore`:

- `.DS_Store`
- `.obsidian/workspace*.json`
- `.obsidian/cache/`
- `.trash/`
- `.obsidian/plugins/obsidian-git/data.json`

WHY THE LAST FILE IS EXCLUDED

Plugin settings can contain authentication-related data. GitHub credentials stay in macOS Keychain and must never be written into a note.

07 HOW TO CONFIRM THE BACKUP WORKED

In Obsidian

Run **Git: Open history view** and confirm the newest commit appears.

On GitHub

Open github.com/ZacharyOhill/completeful-obs and confirm the latest commit and updated file are visible on the `main` branch.

In Terminal

```
cd "/Users/Mac/Agent-Assets-Growth/Completeful"  
git status -sb
```

A fully synchronized result looks like this:

```
## main...origin/main
```

If files are listed underneath that line, they contain local changes that have not yet been committed.

08 TERMINAL FALLBACK

If the Obsidian plugin is unavailable, the same backup can be performed in Terminal:

```
cd "/Users/Mac/Agent-Assets-Growth/Completeful"  
git pull --ff-only  
git add -A  
git commit -m "Update Completeful vault"  
git push
```

If Git says there is nothing to commit, the vault is already saved in the latest local commit.

09 AUTHENTICATION TROUBLESHOOTING

This Mac stores HTTPS credentials in macOS Keychain. Confirm that with:

```
git config --global credential.helper
```

The expected result is:

```
osxkeychain
```

If GitHub asks you to authenticate again:

- 1 Open Terminal.
- 2 Run `gh auth login` and choose GitHub.com and HTTPS.
- 3 Complete the browser login.
- 4 Return to the vault and run `git pull` once.
- 5 Try **Git: Commit-and-sync** again in Obsidian.

DO NOT USE YOUR ACCOUNT PASSWORD

Never type your normal GitHub password in a Git password prompt. GitHub requires an authenticated helper or personal access token for HTTPS Git operations.

10 HANDLING A SYNC CONFLICT

A conflict usually means the same note was changed on two devices before both changes were synchronized.

- 1 Stop editing the conflicted note on other devices.

- 2 Open **Git: Open source control view** in Obsidian.
- 3 Identify the conflicted file.
- 4 Open it and look for conflict markers:

```
<<<<<<<
local version
=====
GitHub version
>>>>>>>
```

- 1 Keep the correct content, combine both versions if needed, and remove all conflict-marker lines.
- 2 Save the note.
- 3 Run **Git: Commit-and-sync with specific message** using a message like `Resolve sync conflict`.

WHEN UNSURE

Make a copy of the note before resolving it. Do not run destructive commands such as `reset --hard` unless you understand exactly which changes will be removed.

11 IMPORTANT SAFETY NOTES

- Keep the GitHub repository **private** — this vault contains internal Completeful information.
- Never place passwords, access tokens, private keys, or customer secrets in vault notes.
- Do not delete the hidden `.git` directory; it stores local version history and the remote connection.
- Do not run **Initialize a new repo** again. This vault is already initialized.
- Do not clone the repository into a folder inside this vault.
- Always finish syncing one device before editing on another device.

PART TWO

12 IMPORT THE VAULT INTO ANOTHER OBSIDIAN

Use this section to bring the entire Completeful vault onto a **new Mac, a second computer, or a fresh Obsidian install** using the GitHub repo. You are cloning the existing repository, not rebuilding the vault by hand.

DO NOT CREATE A BLANK VAULT AND COPY NOTES INTO IT

Doing that breaks the Git connection and can create duplicate, conflicting histories. Always clone `completeful-obs` so the new copy stays linked to GitHub.

Before you start — one-time prerequisites

On the new machine, confirm you have:

- **Obsidian** installed (obsidian.md).
- **Git** installed. On macOS, running `git --version` in Terminal will prompt to install the developer tools if it is missing.
- **Access to the private repo.** You must be signed in as, or invited to, the GitHub account that owns `Zachary0hill/completeful-obs`.
- Optional but recommended: the **GitHub CLI** (`gh`) for the easiest login.

Step 1 — Set up authentication (macOS)

Store credentials in the Keychain so you are not asked to log in on every sync:

```
git config --global credential.helper osxkeychain
```

Then authenticate to GitHub. The simplest path is the GitHub CLI:

```
gh auth login
```

Choose **GitHub.com**, then **HTTPS**, then complete the browser login. If you do not use `gh`, generate a **personal access token** at github.com → Settings → Developer settings, and paste it when Git prompts for a password on the first clone.

Step 2 — Clone the repository

Pick a folder where you keep projects, then clone. This creates a folder named `Completeful` containing the whole vault:

```
cd "/path/where/you/want/the/vault"  
git clone https://github.com/Zachary0hill/completeful-obs.git Completeful
```

WINDOWS / LINUX NOTE

The steps are identical except the credential helper. On Windows use `git config --global credential.helper manager`; on Linux use `git config --global credential.helper store` or the GNOME keyring.

Step 3 — Open it as a vault in Obsidian

- 1 Open Obsidian.
- 2 Choose **Open folder as vault**.
- 3 Select the cloned `Completeful` folder.
- 4 When prompted, **Trust author and enable community plugins** (this vault ships with the Git plugin).
- 5 Confirm the **Git** plugin is enabled under Settings → Community plugins.

IF THE GIT PLUGIN DOES NOT APPEAR

Go to Settings → Community plugins → Browse, search **Obsidian Git**, install and enable it. The repo connection already exists in the cloned folder, so no re-initialization is needed.

Step 4 — Verify the connection and pull

Run **Git: Pull** once via `Command + P` before editing. To confirm in Terminal:

```
cd "/path/where/you/want/the/vault/Completeful"  
git remote -v  
git status -sb
```

You should see `origin` pointing at `completeful-obs` and the branch tracking `origin/main`. You are now fully set up — the everyday workflow in Part One applies from here.

13 NEW-MACHINE CHECKLIST

1. Prereqs

Obsidian + Git installed, access to the private repo

2. Auth

`git config --global credential.helper osxkeychain` then `gh auth login`

3. Clone

`git clone https://github.com/Zachary0hill/completeful-obs.git Completeful`

4. Open

Obsidian → Open folder as vault → select `Completeful`

5. Enable

Trust author + confirm Obsidian Git plugin is on

6. Pull

Run **Git: Pull** once before editing

YOU ARE SET UP CORRECTLY WHEN...

The vault is cloned (not copied), `origin` points at `completeful-obs`, the branch tracks `origin/main`, and credentials live in the Keychain. From here, follow the everyday rule: pull before editing, commit-and-sync before switching devices.

